

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the aim and objective of National Data Sharing and Accessibility Policy (NDSAP)?

NDSAP aims to enable proactive disclosure of shareable data generated by various Government of India entities as Open Government Data on the OGD Platform India [data\[dot\]gov\[dot\]in](http://data.gov.in). The objectives of the Policy are to facilitate access to shareable data managed/owned by various Government of India entities in machine-readable form, in a periodically updatable manner, and within the framework of relevant Acts, Rules and Policies of Government of India, thereby enabling wide access and usage by citizens, researchers and other user groups. Please access the [Policy document](#) for details.

What are the responsibilities of a NDSAP Cell?

The NDSAP Cell chaired by the nominated Chief Data Officer (CDO) is responsible for the following activities:

1. Preparing Negative List of datasets and communicating the same to the Department of Science and Technology (DST).
2. Prepare a schedule of datasets to be released during the upcoming year.
3. Extend Technical Support for preparation of datasets for publication, conversion between file formats (if required), etc.
4. Monitor and manage the open data initiative in their respective Government entity and ensure quality and correctness of the data.
5. Create an open data strategy to promote proactive disclosure of datasets.
6. Institutionalise publication of datasets as part of routine functioning of the Government entity.

What is the recommended organisational size of a NDSAP Cell?

The NDSAP Cell established by a Government entity may be headed by the nominated Chief Data Officer (CDO). The Cell may include as many professionals from allied domains like data analysis, data science, visualisation etc. as may be required to manage and publish the data resources managed/owned by the Government entity concerned.

What is the role of a Data Contributor (DC)?

A Chief Data Officer (CDO) can nominate a number of Data Contributors (DCs) to manage and undertake contribution of datasets for various divisions, offices, organisations, units etc. under the Government entity concerned. DCs can be officers of specific division, office, organisation, unit etc. under the Government entity concerned and be responsible for contribution of datasets managed/owned by the same division, office, organisation, unit etc. The responsibilities of a DC includes the following:

1. Ensuring quality and correctness of datasets to be published
2. Preparing and contributing the dataset, with associated metadata, in the predefined format.

3. Coordinating with and addressing the changes suggested by the CDO, as applicable.

What is the process for contributing datasets to the OGD Platform (<http://data.gov.in/>)?

- Datasets are contributed to the OGD Platform (data.gov.in) through a web-based Data Management System (DMS). The DMS interface can be accessed by designated users of an onboarded Government entity. The Chief Data Officer (CDO) nominated by the Government entity can directly login to the OGD Platform using their NIC Email credentials.
- CDOs that do not have a NIC Email account can use their existing non-NIC Email credentials if the same are mentioned in their nomination letter.
- Additional designated user accounts for the Government entity, that is Data Contributor (DC) accounts, can be created by the CDO once logged in. Once a dataset, with accompanying metadata, is contributed by a DC, the predefined DMS workflow enables the CDO to review the submitted details, ensure compliance with NDSAP and approve the dataset for publication.
- Upon approval by the CDO, the NDSAP PMU at NIC headquarters changes the status of the dataset from 'unpublished' to 'published' and makes it discoverable on the OGD Platform.

What is the role of the NDSAP Project Management Unit (PMU)?

The main activities of the NDSAP PMU includes managing the Open Government Data Platform India data.gov.in, providing Technical Advice to Government entities as per requirements, and enabling contribution of datasets through initiatives such as capacity building of Chief Data Officers and Data Contributors.

What are metadata Elements for catalogs/resources and their usage?

1. Metadata Fields for All Data Catalogs:

- 1.1. Title: A unique name for the catalog.
- 1.2. Description: A detailed description of the catalog.
- 1.3. Keywords: A comma-separated list of terms to describe the contents of the catalog.
- 1.4. Group Name (Optional): A common name for a set of related catalogs to present them on the OGD Platform as part of a group.
- 1.5. Sector & Sub-Sector: Applicable Sector and Sub-Sector that the catalog belong to.
- 1.6. Asset Jurisdiction: The geographic area or location that the contents of the catalog refers to.

2. Metadata Fields for All Data Resources (Datasets and Apps):

- 2.1. Category: Indicates the resource as either a 'Dataset' or an 'Application'.
- 2.2. Title: A unique name for the resource.
- 2.3. Access Method: Identifies the method for accessing the resource with options of “Single Click Link to Dataset” and “Upload a Dataset”.
- 2.4. Reference URLs (Optional): Link/s to documentation, summary of results and other reference materials associated with the resource. In case of multiple URLs, those may be delimited by commas or entered in separate lines.
- 2.5. Access Type: Indicates if the resource is available under Open Access, Registered Access or Restricted Access.

- 2.6. Date Released: Date of publication of the resource on the OGD Platform.
- 2.7. NDSAP Policy Compliance: Indicates if the resource is in compliance with the National Data Sharing and Accessibility Policy of the Government of India.
- 2.8. Frequency (Only for Datasets): Regular interval (such as one-time, hourly, daily, monthly, annual, etc.) at which the dataset is published on the OGD Platform.
- 2.9. Granularity (Only for Datasets): Time interval over which the dataset is/was collected or generated.
- 2.10. App Type (Only for Applications): Indicates the technical category of the app, such as Mobile App, Web App, Web Service, Web Map Service, RSS, etc.
- 2.11. Datasets Used (Only for Applications): Indicates the source details of the dataset/s used to making the app.
- 2.12. Language (Only for Applications): Indicates the language/s in which the app is available.

What are the best practices for Catalog/ Resource (Datasets/Apps) contribution?

Some of the best practices for contribution are as follows:

- Data should be stored in widely used file formats that are suitable for machine processing.
- Released dataset should clearly reflect “what is recorded about a particular subject”.
- Timely release of datasets is one of the important factors to maximize the utility of information people can obtain.
- Data should be provided in freely available formats which can be accessed without the need for a software license.
- Data elements should be in de-normalized form.

What is metadata?

Metadata, or "data about data", provides specific information about one or more aspects of a dataset. Metadata generally contains summary information on:

1. Agency/ies responsible for creating and sharing the dataset.
2. Methodology of data collection/generation.
3. Spatial and temporal resolution of the dataset.
4. Administrative, legal and/or technical conditions under which the dataset is shared etc. to enable effective cataloguing and usage of the dataset etc.

What should be the size of a NDSAP Cell?

In order to implement NDSAP, each Government entity may establish a NDSAP Cell. The size of the Cell may vary from entity to entity as per the quantum of datasets to be published.

What are the roles and responsibilities of a Chief Data Officer (CDO)?

The roles and responsibilities of a Chief Data Officer (CDO) are as follows:

1. Lead the open data initiative of Government entity concerned.
2. Nominate Data Contributors.
3. Create user accounts for Data Contributors by using the CDO's account.
4. Take initiative to release as many datasets as possible on a proactive basis.
5. Identify the High-Value Datasets and schedule their release on the OGD Platform.
6. Prepare the Negative List for the Government entity concerned as per the directions under NDSAP.
7. Ensure that the datasets being published are in compliance with NDSAP.
8. Periodically monitor the release of datasets as per predefined schedule.
9. Take relevant action on the feedback and suggestion received from the citizens regarding the datasets published by the Government entity concerned.
10. Take relevant action on 'Suggestions on New Datasets' submitted by citizens through the OGD Platform.
11. Ensure the correctness of the CDO's contact details made available on the OGD Platform by sending an email/letter to [ndsap\[at\]gov\[dot\]in](mailto:ndsap[at]gov[dot]in) in case of any change.

Who can be nominated as a Chief Data Officer (CDO)?

As per the directive from the Cabinet Secretary, a senior officer at the level of Joint Secretary or above may be nominated by a Government entity as the CDO.

What is the scope of NDSAP?

The National Data Sharing and Accessibility Policy (NDSAP) applies to all data and information created, generated, collected and archived using public funds provided by the Government of India directly or through authorised agencies by various Ministries, Departments, Organizations, Agencies and Autonomous Bodies. Please access the [Policy document](#) for details.

What are guiding principles of the National Data Sharing and Accessibility Policy (NDSAP)?

NDSAP refers to following principles for sharing of Open Government Data: Accessibility, Accountability, Efficiency, Flexibility, Formal Responsibility, Interoperability, Legal Conformity, Openness, Privacy, Professionalism, Protection of Intellectual Property, Quality, Security, Standards, Sustainability and Transparency.

Which agency is responsible for coordination, implementation and monitoring of NDSAP?

The Department of Science and Technology (DST) serves as the nodal agency for coordination and monitoring of NDSP through close collaboration with all Central Government Ministries, including the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), and by creating the OGD Platform India [data\[dot\]gov\[dot\]in](http://data[dot]gov[dot]in) through National Informatics Centre (NIC).

How can datasets be identified for publishing under NDSAP?

As per NDSAP, a Government entity can identify datasets to be published as Open Government Data by creating the following lists after reviewing the datasets it manages/owns:

1. Negative List shall include the datasets that are confidential or sensitive in nature or contains personal (including personally identifiable) information or may compromise matters of national security if made public.
2. Open List shall comprise of datasets that do not fall within the scope of the Negative List. Datasets in the Open List may be further divided into those that are of High-Value and otherwise.

What formats are recommended for publishing of data under NDSAP?

Open government data may be published in a machine-readable manner under NDSAP in the following formats:

1. CSV (Comma Separated Values)
2. GML (Geography Markup Language)
3. KML (Keyhole Markup Language)
4. ODS/OTS (Open Document format for spreadsheets)
5. RDF (Resource Description Framework)
6. RSS/ATOM (suitable for fast changing data updated daily/hourly/etc.)
7. XLS (MS Excel format for spreadsheets)
8. XML (Extensive Markup Language)

How does NDSAP classify different types of data?

NDSAP classifies different types of datasets, generated either in geospatial or in non-spatial form, as:

1. Sensitive
2. Non-shareable
3. Shareable.

Sensitive Data are those that are defined as 'sensitive' in various Acts and Rules of the Government of India.

Non-shareable Data are those that are declared as not-suitable for sharing by the Government entity concerned.

Shareable Data are those that are neither sensitive in nature nor declared as non-suitable for sharing by the Government entity concerned.

Does NDSAP include budget provisions?

Budgetary provisions for implementation of NDSAP including for establishment of the NDSAP Cell and for appropriate support of data management activities, are met from the internal budget of the respective Government entities.

How can a Government entity implement NDSAP?

In order to implement NDSAP, a Government entity can undertake the following activities:

1. Nominate an officer, at the level of Joint Secretary or above, as the Chief Data Officer (CDO).
2. Nominate Data Contributors (DCs) to coordinate on behalf of different Divisions, Projects, Schemes, Units etc.
3. Create Login IDs for the DCs by using the CDO's account.
4. Setup NDSAP Cell.
5. Identify datasets to be shared and prepare Negative List.
6. Create Action Plan to schedule regular release of datasets.
7. Publish datasets on OGD Platform India.
8. Monitor and manage the Open Data Program of the entity concerned.

How can I contact the NDSAP Project Management Unit (PMU)?

The contact details of NDSAP PMU can be found on "[Contact Us](#)" page.